

mandiant/Vulnerability-Disclosures: 2026/MNDT-2026-0009.md

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MNDT-2026-0009.md

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MNDT-2026-0009

Description

Deployments of KnowledgeDeliver may have been implemented with a pre-shared ASP.NET machine key. This vulnerable configuration can enable ASP.NET ViewState deserialization attacks, leading to remote code execution.

Impact

High: This vulnerability enables an adversary to circumvent ASP.NET ViewState validation mechanisms and remotely execute unauthorized code.

Exploitability

High: Any unauthenticated user that has the pre-shared ASP.NET machine key can exploit the vulnerability to achieve remote code injection.

CVE ID

CVE-2026-5426

Common Weakness Enumeration

- CWE-502: Deserialization of Untrusted Data
- CWE-798: Use of Hard-coded Credentials

Technical Details

Adversaries may target KnowledgeDeliver deployments with malicious ViewState payloads. These payloads are crafted using a specific machine key that was used in deployments until February 24, 2026. These payloads can lead to OS-level remote code execution.

Impacted Configurations:

- Default ASP.NET machine key has not been changed by an organization
- Application is accessible by the threat actor (open to the internet)

CVSS: CVSS:3.1/AV:N/AC:H/PR:N/UI:N/S:C/C:H/I:H/A:H

Resolution

- Generate a unique, cryptographically strong machineKey for each KnowledgeDeliver instance

Discovery Credits

- Takahiro Sugiyama, Mandiant
- Peter Revelant, Mandiant

Disclosure Timeline

- 2026-01-19: Call with Digital Knowledge to report the issue
- 2026-02-24: Digital Knowledge implemented their updated deployment procedure to address the issue
- 2026-03-18: Call with Digital Knowledge to discuss disclosure
- 2026-04-16: Mandiant advisory published

References

- <https://www.cve.org/CVERecord?id=CVE-2026-5426>
- <https://www.digital-knowledge.co.jp/product/kd/>

- <https://cloud.google.com/blog/topics/threat-intelligence/knowledgedeliver-viewstate-deserialization-vulnerability>

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